



December 10th 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KWxJr8TQa4M
Publication Date	2019-12-11T19:02:00Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Delaware County Council meeting was called to order by the presiding officer, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Scott Alexander, Jessica Piper, Larry Bledsoe, Ryan (and other responding council members during roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Scott Alexander (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The approval of the prior meeting's minutes was formally postponed until the January meeting because the minutes were received late that morning, leaving no adequate time for review.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:08 Financial & Budget Transfers Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna Patterson (Auditor)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Auditor reported that a bank loan was successfully paid off (\$350,000 compared to \$1.3 million the previous year), bringing interest down significantly (\$5,288 compared to \$17,370). She reviewed preliminary budget notices for the upcoming year and discussed various departmental fund transfers for year-end balancing (including jury trials, circuit court lines, and equipment purchases).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:17:11 Sheriff's Department Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to transfer funds from line 223 (Vehicle Maintenance), totaling \$17,777, into machinery and equipment to outfit vehicles before year-end.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:21:17 Public Defender / Court Reporter Year-End Financial Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey (Office Manager, Public Defender's Office)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Explanation of year-end transfers to cover high-dollar appeal transcripts, outside counsel for trials, and final payouts for a retiring court reporter to avoid encumbrances.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:25:50 Board Appointments for 2020**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Scott Alexander / Jessica Piper
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and confirmation of 2020 board reappointments. Discussion was held regarding the historical practice of appointing an ex-officio member to the Fair Board (traditionally Ted), clarifying that while not an official statutory appointment by county bylaws, it has been maintained out of respect and tradition.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:30:30 2020 Meeting Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Leadership
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and adoption of the meeting calendar schedule for the year 2020.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

- **00:32:57 Election of Council Officers for 2020**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Floor
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Nominations and election for Council President for 2020. Scott Alexander was nominated and unanimously elected.
 - Nominations and election for Council Vice President for 2020. Jessica Piper was nominated, seconded, and elected.
 - Outgoing president remarks and presentation of a President's Service Award.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Scott Alexander as President; Jessica Piper as Vice President).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:36:08 Larry (Resident / Local Community Perspective)**
 - Addressed the history of funding for the Veterans Education Officer grant and Ralph Smith's position. Clarified misunderstandings regarding budget lines, transitions, part-time vs. full-time allocations for 2020, and collaborative efforts between the Council, Commissioners, and Ball State.
 - **00:44:28 Nate Jones (Delaware County Veterans Affairs Officer)**
 - Spoke on the critical value provided by the Veterans Affairs office, the high return on investment of federal dollars injected into the local economy, and the need for a smooth, supported transitional phase for staffing following Ralph Smith's retirement.
 - **00:54:43 Ralph Smith (Retiring Veterans Officer / Local Hero)**
 - Expressed gratitude to the Council and Commissioners for establishing and supporting the veterans' position over his tenure, sharing brief reflections on his military and public service history and advocating continued support for Nate Jones and the office staff.
 - **01:00:38 Regional VSO Representative**
 - Spoke in strong support of maintaining funding for the Delaware County Veterans Service Office, noting based on oversight across 16 counties that Delaware County's office ranks among the absolute best in the state for efficiency, federal benefit retrieval, and community impact.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Council members exchanged holiday greetings and noted procedural reminders regarding hiring protocols through Human Resources effective after the first of the

year.

- **Adjournment:**

- **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **Time:** Not explicitly stated by timestamp, occurring immediately following the final remarks.

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